

# Thinner, lighter, better

## A look at the current generation of Netbooks

The era of netbooks dawned upon us two years ago when Asus gave the world the first Eee PC. Its physical attributes suggested that such devices would mostly be intended for kids; as their first cheap-but-real portable computers. But they appealed to an older audience as well; serving the purpose of a secondary machine that could be back-packed anywhere. The "flaws" of the first generation were

fixed in the second; screens became bigger, keyboards more comfortable to use, large-sized spinning hard-disks replaced measly-sized SSDs, Windows XP replaced Linux. The result is that the netbook has become acceptable to a wider variety of people. Those looking for a cheap portable PC to use their internet and productivity apps prefer to buy these over clunky cheap laptops.

There are three selling factors that tempt the audience;

the size, the price and battery life. Also, netbooks can now pretty much do the same basic tasks as your desktop computer or laptop (although somewhat slower). We are now looking at the third generation of netbooks; they are growing out of their 10-inch screen size, becoming slicker and slimmer than before, and performing even better; especially in the graphics department. NVIDIA's upcoming Ion platform is the testament to that. The Ion

From the somewhat-painful-to-use first generation models that many people disapproved of, netbooks have come a long way. Here, we take a look at the latest breed of netbooks available in the market today

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